

Vivo X300 Ultra

Raising the bar for what a flagship should be in 2026

There are flagship smartphones, and then there is the Vivo X300 Ultra. And

I don't mean that in the usual reviewer way, where everything sounds like a big deal in the first paragraph. It's one of those phones that initially grows on you, and then at some point you realise, okay, this is special. For me, it slots right alongside the Galaxy S26 Ultra and the iPhone 17 Pro Max. And up until now, if someone randomly asked me what flagship phone to buy, I have always instinctively said Samsung or Apple, because they are safe, familiar choices. But this time, if anyone asks me the same question, I will pause. Because if you actually have the money to spend (over Rs 1.5 lakh here), I feel like saying, just go buy the X300 Ultra.

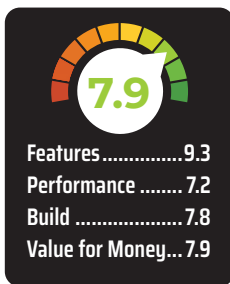
There are camera phones, and then there is the Vivo X300 Ultra. It has reset my expectations for a flagship phone in 2026.

THE CAMERA

The Vivo X300 Ultra doesn't just have a good camera system; it's a proper, fully loaded setup, which tells you that Vivo just went all in. I remember using the Vivo X200 Pro, and I thought that was peak smartphone photography. Nothing I tried after that, including the Xiaomi 14 Ultra, really matched the Vivo experience. And now the X300 Ultra just takes that idea and goes beyond. Also, it's not just that it takes great photos. A lot of phones do that now. It's how much control it gives you, and how consistently it delivers.

There are so many ways to shoot on this phone. You have your regular auto

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mode, which already does a solid job. But once you step into Pro mode, you start seeing what Vivo is trying to do here. You get full manual control, and yes, you can shoot in LOG as well.

And, did I tell you about the ridiculous zoom on this phone? And I don't mean

to say that in a spec-sheet bragging manner, but in the sense that it is actually usable. You simply go in, frame your shot, and still get detail that holds up. Plus, in doing so, the phone doesn't even flinch, be it daylight or low-light.

You get multiple focal lengths: 14mm, 35mm, 85mm, 170mm, and even 230mm. And it's not just there for show. You actually end up using them depending on the situation. I know I used a lot of 35mm for something natural, 85mm for that classic portrait look, and then the longer ones when I

wanted something more dramatic. The good part is that the output just hits. I am literally at a loss for words on how good the camera on this thing is. In photos, the skin tones look natural. There is no weird over-processing. The background separation is clean and not overly artificial. There's a certain character to these images that is really hard

to explain, but very easy to notice once you start using the phone. And boy, is it a joy using this camera!

In general photos, it's the same story. You get excellent detail and dynamic range, but more importantly, you get consistency.

You don't have to second-guess whether the shot will come out well. I mean, you really have to be a bad photographer to capture a bad photo on the Vivo X300 Ultra.

There are also a lot of editing tools built in. Enough that you can actually finish your photos on the phone itself without jumping to Canva or even Photoshop.

And, if you are still not down with all this, there's the whole ecosystem around the camera: the teleconverter kit (200mm and 400mm lenses) and the shooting rig. I, alongside my team, actually used this setup to shoot a short film called The Proof, which is up on the Digit YouTube channel.

Speaking of video recording, I think Vivo has really stepped up this year. You see, photos were already sorted, but the video now feels properly flagship-level. Stabilisation is solid, colours are consistent, and it handles lighting really well. I would again bring up the example of our short film, because we shot it during the day and evening, indoors and outdoors, and the footage turned out very usable without much effort.

In fact, just last weekend, I even ended up comparing the X300 Ultra with our Sony A7III camera. A proper camera is still a proper camera. But when I took those photos of Krishika, side by side, from both devices, there were moments where the Vivo held its